

View results

Respondent

59

Anonymous

44:11

Time to complete

A. General information about the respondent

1. * Country

Gambia



2. * Name of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

Ministry of Higher Education Research Science and Technology

3. * Website of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

www.moherst.gov.gm

4. * Email address of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

5. Phone number of organization(s) or entity(s) responsible for the preparation of the report

6. Please describe the role/mandate of your organization

The Ministry of Higher Education, Research and Technology (MoHERST) was established in February 2007 and began operations in March 2007. It is responsible for policy development and the management and coordination of programmes and activities relating to higher education, research, science, and technology.

The role and importance of tertiary and higher education in the process of national development have been acknowledged and emphasized globally. Therefore, in order to achieve sustainable socio-economic development in The Gambia, it is important to reaffirm the relationship between tertiary and higher education and the workforce and how these steers the development drives stipulated in the country's National Development Plan (RF-NDP 2023-2027), and other national policies and strategy initiatives.

7. * Full name of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

Samba Sowe

8. * Position of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

Director of Science Technology and Innovation

9. * Email address of officially designated contact person(s) who completed this survey

10. Full Name(s) of designated official(s) certifying the report

Mr. Mucktarr M.Y Darboe

11. Brief description of the consultation process established for the preparation of the report

STI Ministries and agencies engaged and their policies and strategies referenced.

12. * Name of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

Ministry of Communication and Digital Economy, Ministry of Trade Industry and Employment, University of The Gambia, University of Applied Sciences, Engineering and Technology

13. * Website of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey
(Please use commas to separate multiple links, as: link A, link B)

www.mocde.gov.gm: www.utg.edu.gm: www.uset.gov.gm: www.motie.gov.gm

14. * Email address of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey

15. Sector of other organization(s) or entit(y)(ies) (including non-governmental) consulted for completing this survey



Public



Private



Civil Society



Other

B. QUESTIONNAIRE FOR MEMBER STATES' REPORTING

ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE 2021 RECOMMENDATION ON OPEN SCIENCE

Part 1. PROMOTING A COMMON UNDERSTANDING OF OPEN SCIENCE,

ASSOCIATED BENEFITS AND CHALLENGES, AS WELL AS DIVERSE PATHS TO OPEN
SCIENCE

16. 1.1 Has the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science been promoted and/or shared with appropriate ministries and institutions as well as affiliated organizations in your country?



Yes



No

17. 1.1 cont. **If yes**, please indicate which ministries and or national authorities/entities have been involved in the promotion of the 2021 Recommendation.

Ministry of Higher Education Research Science and Technology

18. 1.2 Is the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science available in the national language(s) of your country?

☐ Yes

☒ No

19. 1.3 Have there been awareness raising activities on open science, including all its key elements[i], associated benefits and challenges, organized or foreseen to be organized by the end of 2025 in your country by national authorities or entities? (ref.: (i) 16.f, 16.g, 16.h)

[i] Please refer to the elements of open science defined in the 2021 Recommendation, namely : open scientific knowledge (including open access to scientific publications, research data, open educational resources, open-source software and code, open hardware), open science infrastructures, open engagement of societal actors and open dialogue with other knowledge systems.

☐ Yes

☒ No

20. 1.4 Have specific actions been undertaken or are planned to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to incorporate the values and principles of open science[i], in publicly funded research? (ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h)

[i] The 2021 Recommendation outlines a set of shared values of open science stemming from the rights-based, ethical, epistemological, economic, legal, political, social, multi-stakeholder and technological implications of opening science to society and broadening the principles of openness to the whole cycle of scientific research. It also provides a set of guiding principles, as a framework for enabling conditions and practices, which uphold the values of open science and can realize the ideals of open science.

Please see the values of open science, namely quality and integrity, collective benefit, equity and fairness, and diversity and inclusiveness.

Please see the guiding principles for open science ,namely transparency, scrutiny, critique and reproducibility; equality of opportunities; responsibility, respect and accountability; collaboration, participation and inclusion; flexibility and sustainability.

☒ Yes

☐ No

21. 1.4 cont. If **yes**, please indicate the actions that are taken to incorporate the specific values and principles. For each case, please provide details and links as relevant.

MoHERST will review the national STI policy before end of 2025 and intent to incorporate open science values and principles.

Part 2. DEVELOPING AN ENABLING POLICY ENVIRONMENT FOR OPEN SCIENCE

22. 2.1 Does your country have a national policy[i], strategy or plan of action on science, technology and innovation (STI)?

[i] National STI policy is most commonly a governmental document developed by governing bodies leading the STI policy design and implementation in a given country, which formulates objectives and guides actions and decision-making processes in the area of STI on the national level.

☒ Yes

☐ No

23. 2.1 cont. **If yes**

· please share a machine-readable PDF file of the policy using this link: <https://tinyurl.com/27p5zct8> designating openscience@unesco.org as the recipient, and provide the following information: *Title of the policy, the authority in charge of development of the policy, entities involved and the process of development, year of adoption, year of last update, key areas/sections of the policy, and links to the webpage if available.*

In the comment box, please indicate the question number for this attachment / document.

After uploading, please return to this page to continue the survey.

National STI Policy 2013 – 2024, MoHERST

24. 2.1 cont. **If yes:**

- does it include any of the following open science elements:

- ☐ open access to scientific knowledge
- ☐ open science infrastructure
- ☐ open engagement of societal actors
- ☐ open dialogue with other knowledge systems

25. 2.2 In your country, is there a policy, or a set of policies and/or legal framework(s)[i] at the national level that address open science or any of its key elements in line with the definition, values and principles outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: (i) 16.a, 16.b, 16.c, 16.d, 16.e, 16.h)

[i] These can include specific national policies, sets of guidelines, rules, regulations, laws, principles, or directions to govern open science practices.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☒ No

26. 2.2 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policies.

The lack of open science policy, but there plans to review the National STI policy before end of 2025 and incorporate open science. However, we are faced with some funding challenges to review the National STI policy.

27. 2.3 In your country, are there specific policy instruments[i] that aim to promote open science?

[i] Policy instruments include programmes, methods and mechanisms of technical and operational nature, required to solve the issues set by the policy, with focus on the target beneficiaries, resources, indicators, and set of goals for delivering products (short term), results (medium-term), and impacts (long term).

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

28. 2.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policy instruments.

There are plans to promote open science but there is no specific policy instruments to do so.

29. 2.4 In your country, is there a national implementation plan, strategy, policy or a roadmap for implementation of open science at the national level in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.a, 17.b, 17.c, 17.f, 17.h)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

30. 2.4 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such policy instruments.

There are plans, but due to lack of policy instrument it is difficult to Implementation open science

31. 2.5 In your country, are there policies and/or strategies that promote open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation at **institutional** level, including in the context of research-performing institutions, universities, scientific unions and associations and learned societies? (ref.: (ii) 17.d, 17.e, 17.g)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

32. 2.6 In your country, are there specific funding mechanisms[i] for open science at the national level? (ref.: (ii) 17.j, (iii) 18.j, (iv) 19.c)

[i] A funding mechanism refers to a policy instrument or process through which financial resources are allocated or provided for a specific purpose. Some examples are block funding, research grants, support for technological poles and centres of excellence, support for science parks and innovation centres, Infrastructure grants (for research facilities, labs, instruments), communication and outreach funds, innovation funds, loans and tax credits scholarships, studentships, fellowships, trust funds, sectoral funds.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

33. 2.6 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to develop such funding mechanisms.

There are plans, but due to Lack of an Open Science Policy there are no funding mechanisms

34. 2.7 1.1 In your country, have open science practices[i] been integrated in existing research funding mechanisms?

[i] Examples can include sharing open scientific knowledge (publications, research data, educational resources, software and hardware) with other scientists and with the public, sharing or using open infrastructures, collaboration with other researchers, with national and local societal actors such as policy makers, or sectors such as industry, agriculture, and health, and collaboration and open dialogue with indigenous peoples and local communities.

☐ Yes

☒ No

35. 2.7 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

There are no funding mechanisms but when the policy is developed the funding mechanism will be put in place.

36. 2.8 Have efforts been made or are foreseen to be undertaken by end of 2025 in your country to foster equitable public-private partnerships on open science in line with the 2021 Recommendation? (ref.: (ii) 17.i)

☐ Yes

☒ No

37. 2.8 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

There plans, but due to the lack of policy it remains a challenge

38. 2.9 Is there a national monitoring framework for open science in your country? Or are there specific indicators on open science included in the national monitoring and evaluation framework for STI policy (ref.: (ii) 17.j, 23.c)

☐ Yes

☐ Under development

☒ No

Part 3. INVESTING IN OPEN SCIENCE INFRASTRUCTURES AND SERVICES

39. 3.1 What is the latest official data for your country's percentage of national gross domestic product (GDP) dedicated to research and development expenditure? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.a)

0.07 percentage as per the last R&D and innovation survey in 2021, covering 2018 to 2020. There are plans to conduct a similar survey this year.

40. 3.2 What is the latest official data for the percentage of your country's population that have access to reliable internet and bandwidth? Please also indicate the year of publication of this data, and to which year(s) it refers. (ref.: (iii) 18.b)

60 Percent as per the 2024 Gambia Bureau of Statistic Census Report

41. 3.3 Are there national research and education networks (NRENs)[i] active in the country? (ref.: (iii) 18.c)

[i] A national research and education network (NREN) is a specialised internet service provider dedicated to supporting the needs of the research and education communities within a country.

☐ Yes

☒ No

42. 3.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to establish them.

Currently there are ongoing activities to establish a REN, however there are some funding challenges hindering its establishment.

43. 3.4 Are there national or institutional open science infrastructures[i] in your country? (ref.: (iii) 18.d, 18.e, 18.k, 18.l, 18.m)

[i] Some examples of open science infrastructures include major shared scientific equipment or sets of instruments, open computational and data manipulation service infrastructures that enable collaborative and multidisciplinary data analysis, open science platforms and repositories for publications, research data and source codes, archives, open bibliometrics and scientometrics systems for assessing and analysing scientific domains, open laboratories, software forges and virtual research environments, open innovation testbeds, incubators, science museums, science parks and infrastructure for non-digital materials.

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Under development
- ☒ No

44. 3.4 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

There are plans, but the lack of policy still remains a challenge

45. 3.5 Does your country host or fund any federated regional or international information technology infrastructure for open science? (ref.: (iii) 18.e, 18.f)

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

46. 3.5. cont. **If no**, are the existing open science infrastructures at regional and international levels accessible to all the relevant open science actors from your country?

☐

Yes

☒

No

☐

Other

47. 3.6 Is your country involved in any North-South, North-South-South and South-South collaborations to optimize infrastructure use and joint strategies for shared, multinational, regional and national open science platforms? (ref.: (iii) 18.g)

☐

Yes

☒

No

Part 4. INVESTING IN HUMAN RESOURCES, TRAINING, EDUCATION, DIGITAL LITERACY

AND CAPACITY BUILDING FOR OPEN SCIENCE

48. 4.1 Has systematic capacity building on open science taken place in higher education and/or research performing institutions in your country? (ref.: (iv) 19.a, 19.c)

☐

Yes

☒

No

49. 4.1 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Plans are on the way, but Institutional readiness for open science is a challenge

50. 4.2 Have capacity building programmes for policy makers on how to integrate core values and principles of open science in STI policies and strategies taken place in your country?

☐ Yes

☒ No

51. 4.2 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Lack of Policy and National readiness. However, this will be relevant as the country is about to review the national STI policy and incorporate open science values and principles.

52. 4.3 Has a framework of open science competencies been incorporated into higher education research skills curricula in your country, or is it foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (iv) 19.b)

☐ Yes

☒ No

53. 4.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Open Science is not yet fully embraced at institutional level but there are plans to do so.

54. 4.4 Are open educational resources[i] as defined in the 2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources, used as an instrument for open science capacity building in your country in line with the 2019 Recommendation mentioned above? (ref.: (iv) 19.d)

[i] Open Educational Resources are learning, teaching and research materials in any format and medium that reside in the public domain or are under copyright that have been released under an open license, that permit no-cost access, re-use, re-purpose, adaptation and redistribution by others (2019 Recommendation on Open Educational Resources)

- ☐ Yes
- ☐ Partly
- ☒ No

55. 4.5 Have there been any initiatives in your country to support science communication in line with open science value and principles with a view to the dissemination of scientific knowledge to researchers of different disciplines, decision-makers and the public at large? (ref.: (iv) 19.e)

- ☐ Yes
- ☒ No

56. 4.5 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Open Science is not yet fully embraced at institutional level but there are plans to do so.

Part 5. FOSTERING A CULTURE OF OPEN SCIENCE AND ALIGNING INCENTIVES FOR OPEN SCIENCE

57. 5.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level, e.g. by universities and/or research performing institutions, to review the existing research assessment and evaluation processes in order to align them with open science principles and values or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.b, 20c, 20i)

☐ Yes

☒ No

58. 5.1 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

There were such initiatives years ago, but due to funding challenges the initiative was not sustained. However, there are plans to revitalise the initiatives

59. 5.2 Have specific clauses that recognize open science practices, including sharing, collaborating and engaging with other researchers and societal actors beyond the scientific community, or dialogue with other knowledge systems, been incorporated in the career evaluation and progression systems or are foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.c, 20.d)

☐ Yes

☒ No

60. 5.2 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Lack of Policy and National readiness. However, this will be relevant as the country is about to review the national STI policy and incorporate open science values and principles.

61. 5.3 Have there been any initiatives in your country to recognize and reward open science practices or are they foreseen by the end of 2025? (ref.: (v) 20.a, 20.b, 20.c, 20.e, 20.f, 20.g, 20h)

☐ Yes

☒ No

62. 5.3 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Lack of research assessment standards and tools, but plans are on the way

63. 5.4 Have there been any unintended negative consequences[i] of open science practices reported in your country? (ref.: (v) 20)

[i] For example, predatory behaviours, data migration, exploitation and privatization of research data, increased costs for scientists and high article processing charges associated with certain business models in scientific publishing that may be causes of inequality for the scientific communities around the world and, in some cases, the loss of intellectual property and knowledge.

☐ Yes

☒ No

Part 6. PROMOTING INNOVATIVE APPROACHES FOR OPEN SCIENCE AT DIFFERENT STAGES OF THE SCIENTIFIC PROCESS

64. 6.1 Have there been any initiatives at the national or institutional level that promote innovative, participatory methodological or procedural changes at different stages of the research cycle to increase the openness of the entire scientific process? (ref.: (vi) 21)

- ☐ YES, at the national level
- ☐ YES, at the institutional level
- ☐ YES, at both the national and institutional levels
- ☒ No

65. 6.1 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Open Science is not yet implemented

Part 7. PROMOTING INTERNATIONAL AND MULTI- STAKEHOLDER COOPERATION IN THE CONTEXT OF OPEN SCIENCE AND WITH VIEW TO REDUCING DIGITAL, TECHNOLOGICAL AND KNOWLEDGE GAPS

66. 7.1 How is your country promoting and facilitating international scientific collaborations on open science as outlined in the 2021 Recommendation on Open Science? (ref.: (vii) 22.a)

Presently The Gambia is collaborating with Organisation of Southern Cooperation to establish an Inter-disciplinary Research for Africa Centre in the Gambia

67. 7.2 Does your country have a strategy or a plan for stimulating cross-border multi-stakeholder collaboration on open science, including with regards to exchange of best practices, capacity building and metrics for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.b, 22.e, 22.f)

☐ Yes

☒ No

68. 7.2 cont. **If no**, please, if possible, briefly explain the reason and the difficulties or obstacles in this area and indicate if there are plans to do so.

Funding challenges to develop one.

69. 7.3 Is your country involved in any discussion on the establishment of regional and international funding mechanisms for open science? (ref.: (vii) 22.c)

☒ Yes

☐ No

70. 7.3 cont. **If yes**, please provide links as relevant and more information.

Establishment of Research and innovation Funds at national and regional (ECOWAS) levels

Part 8. GENERAL CONSIDERATIONS

71. 8.1 Are there any specific external causes that may impede the implementation of the 2021 UNESCO Recommendation on Open Science in your country?

☒ Yes

☐ No

72. 8.1 cont. **If yes**, please provide more information.

Coordination challenges and capacity both in terms of technical and human.

73. ANY OTHER COMMENTS: If you wish, you may enter any additional comments or information here. You may also contact openscience@unesco.org

We would need UNESCO's support in developing an Open Science Policy and developing related capacities in this regard.